Acme Engineering — New Hire Onboarding Guide

Sample content for demonstrating PDF ingestion in a RAG system. Fictional process.

Day 1: Access & Setup

Your first day is about getting access, not shipping code. You will receive invitations to GitHub, the cloud console, the secrets manager, and Slack. Enable two-factor authentication on every account before doing anything else — accounts without 2FA are automatically suspended after 24 hours.

- Install the toolchain with `make bootstrap`.
- Request access to the `backend` and `infra` teams in the access portal.
- Pair with your onboarding buddy to get the app running locally.

Week 1: The Codebase

Spend your first week reading before writing. Trace one request from the API layer through the service layer to the database. Your first pull request should be small and intentionally low-risk — a documentation fix, a test, or a tiny bug. The goal is to exercise the full workflow, not to make an impact yet.

Git Workflow

We use trunk-based development. Branch from `main`, keep branches short-lived, and open a pull request early as a draft. Every PR requires one approval and a green CI run before merge. Commits should be small and described in the imperative mood. Never commit secrets — the pre-commit hook will block them, but treat that as a safety net, not a strategy.

Deployment

Merging to `main` triggers an automatic deploy to staging. Production deploys are promoted manually after a smoke test passes. Rollbacks are a single command and are always preferred over a forward-fix under pressure. If you break production, say so immediately in the incident channel — speed of disclosure matters more than the mistake.

On-Call

Engineers join the on-call rotation after their first month. On-call shifts run one week and are compensated. The expectation is to acknowledge a page within 15 minutes, not to fix everything alone — escalate early and often. Every incident is followed by a blameless postmortem focused on systems, not individuals.

Getting Help

Ask questions in public channels rather than direct messages, so the whole team benefits from the answer. There are no stupid questions in your first 90 days — and frankly, rarely after. If you are blocked for more than 30 minutes, that is a signal to ask, not to keep grinding.